AUTOMATIONS · FOR STARTUPS

# 5

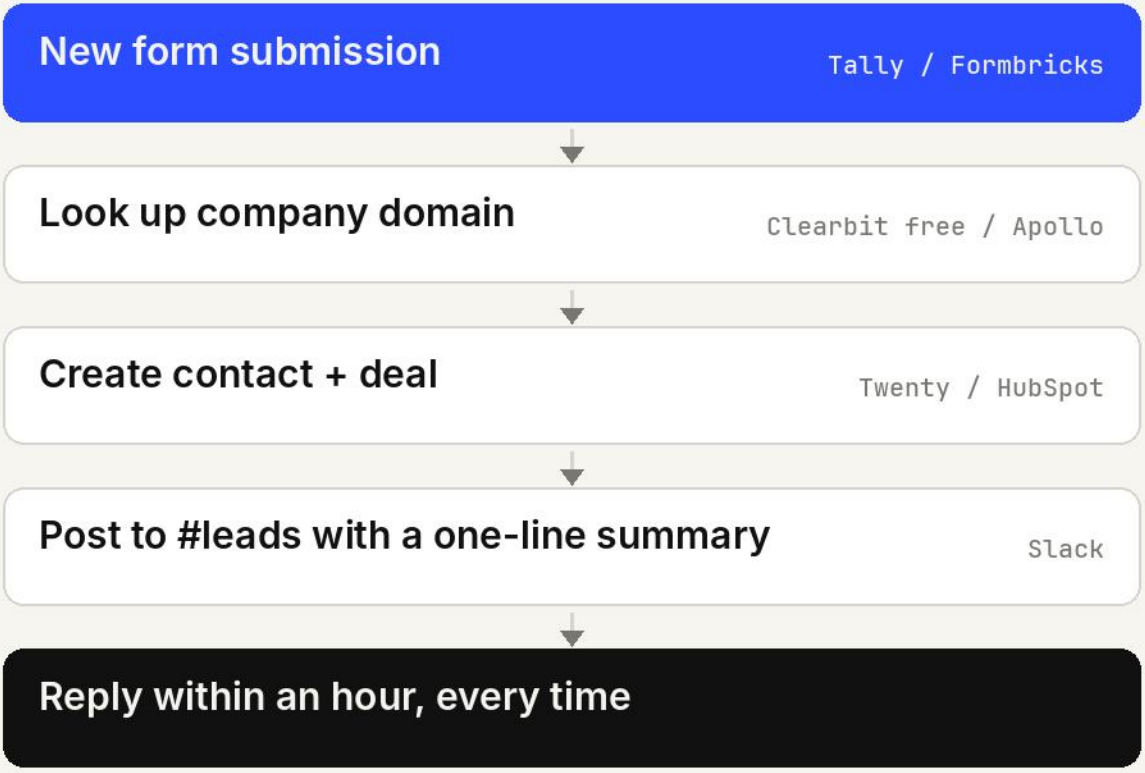
automations we'd have running by month three

## Not the fancy ones. The five that stop small things falling through the cracks.

Each one is six nodes or fewer in n8n, Make or Zapier. Build time is an afternoon each if you've done one before, a weekend if you haven't.

1 · LEAD INTAKE

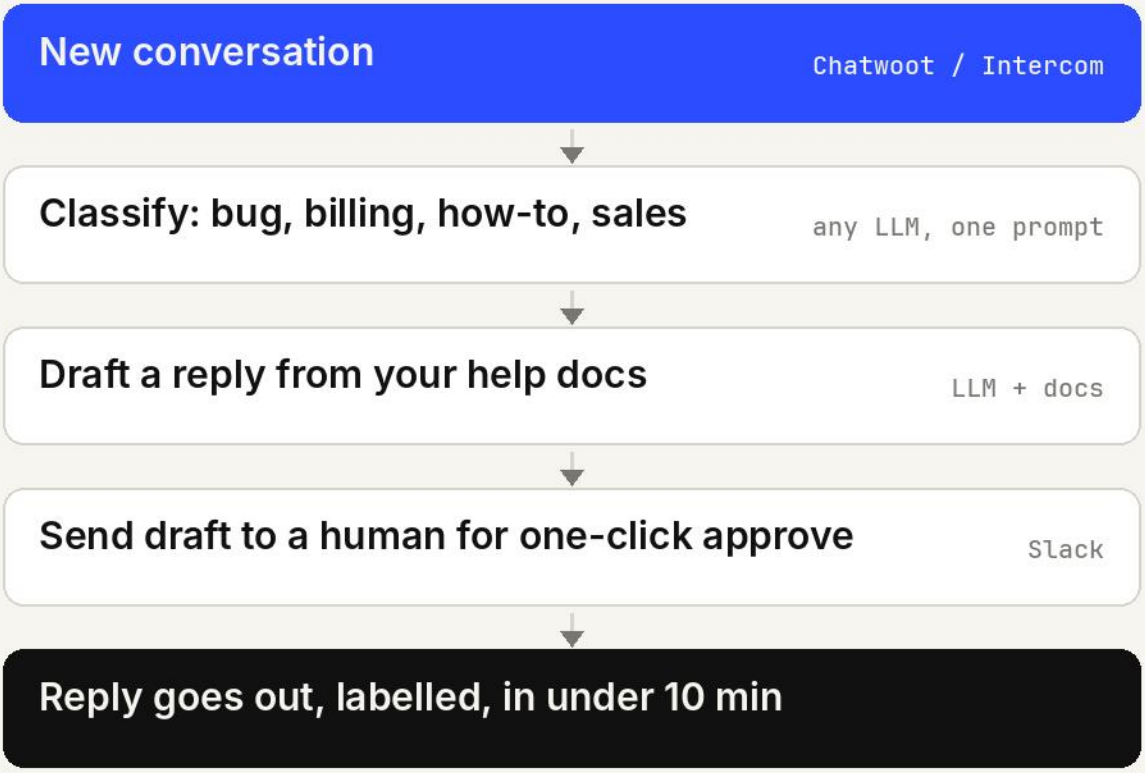
# Every form fill becomes a CRM record and a Slack ping, with the company looked up




The win isn't speed. It's that nobody has to remember to check the form inbox.

2 · SUPPORT TRIAGE

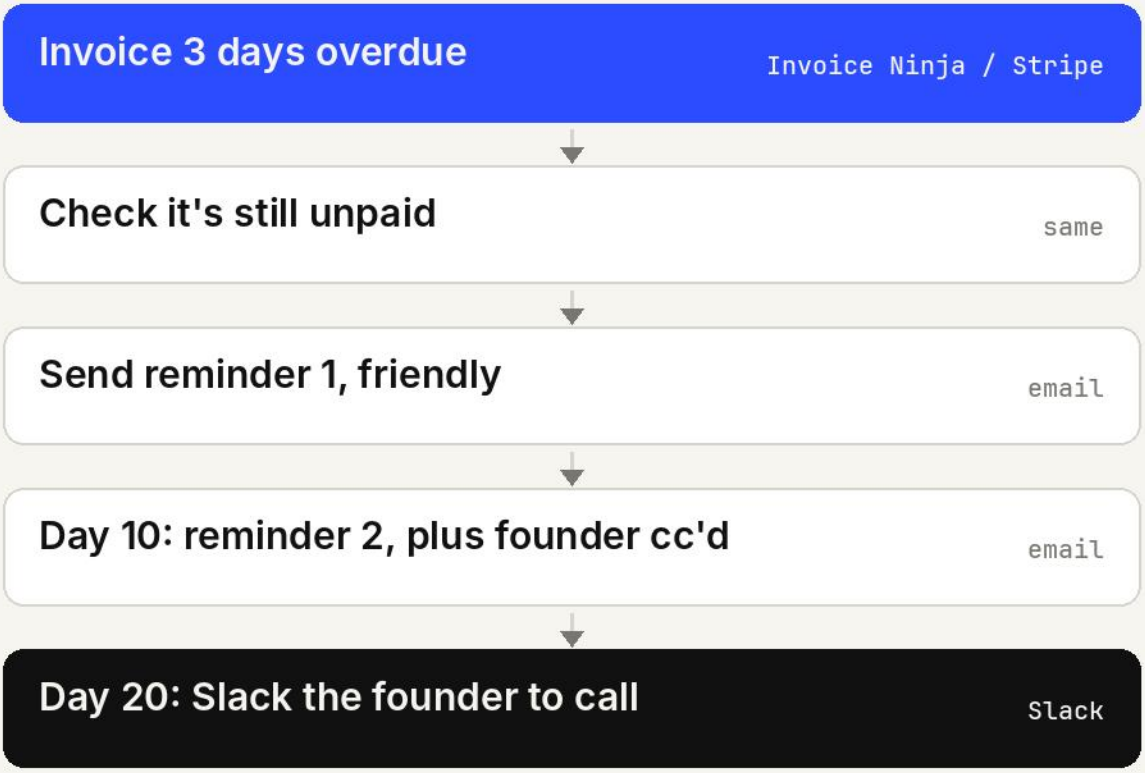
# Tickets get sorted before a human reads them




Keep the human approve step for at least a month. Then look at what they never edit.

3 · INVOICE CHASING

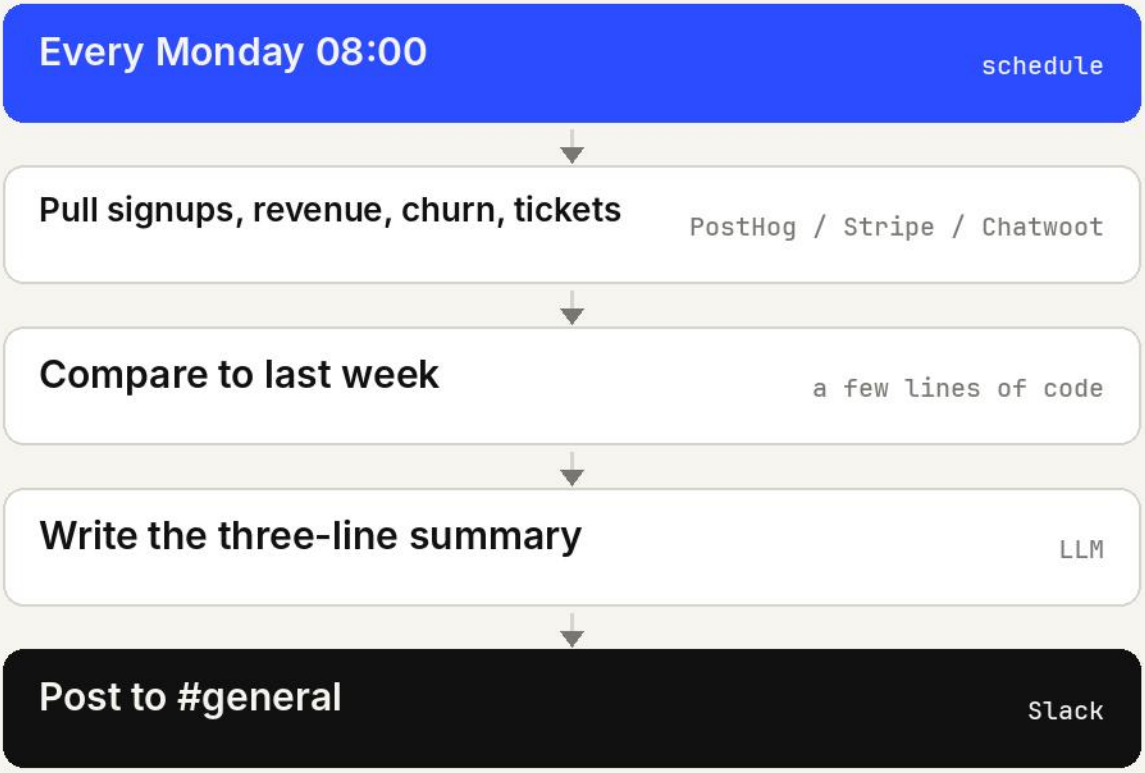
# Unpaid invoices chase themselves, politely




Most late payments are forgotten, not refused. The first reminder clears half of them.

4 · WEEKLY NUMBERS

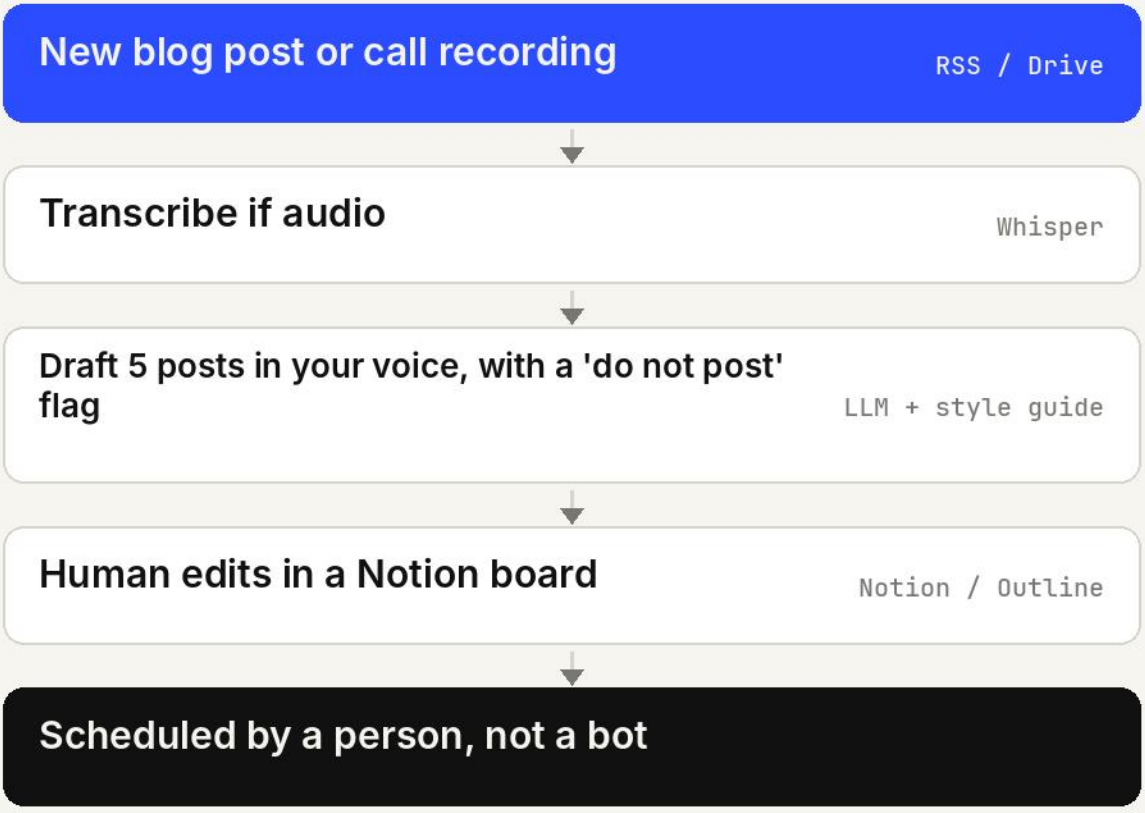
# Monday 8am, the numbers arrive before anyone asks




If the summary ever says 'everything is fine', fix the prompt. Something is never fine.

5 · CONTENT REPURPOSING

# One long thing becomes five short things




The bot drafts. A person decides. The posts that skip the person are the ones readers flag as slop.

WHICH TOOL FOR THE PLUMBING

# n8n vs Make vs Zapier, for a startup

| | Zapier / Make | n8n |
|---|---|---|
| Running in 10 minutes | ✓ | – |
| Free tier that covers five automations | – | ✓ |
| Self-host, own the data | – | ✓ |
| Bill grows with runs | ✓ | – |
| Someone else keeps it up | ✓ | – |
| AI agent nodes built in | ✓ | ✓ |

If nobody on the team has run Docker, start on Make. Move to n8n when the bill makes you wince.

THE RULE WE KEEP COMING BACK TO



# Automate the thing you've done by hand twenty times. Not the thing you imagine doing.

— Founder Signal

# Which of the five would you build first?

Tell us in the comments. The most-requested one gets a full node-by-node build next week.

Follow Founder Signal